



## How We Tested

We roped in a couple of experts to provide comments and feedback for all the software we tested. We kept some features as bases for the software to qualify for the tests, for example, that the software should have a backup and restore option. We expected that basic reports such as Trial Balance, Profit and Loss (PNL) and balance sheet would be provided. We looked for a facility to export reports to common office applications such as MS Excel, Acrobat Reader, etc. In the inventory section, we scanned for options such as type of stock valuation. Some of the newer-generation reports, too, were part of what we looked for—aging reports, sale/purchase price lists, and features such as transaction analysis, online bill adjustment, and date-wise locking.

To test the ease-of-use factor, we had a set of eight

accounting entries which we posted in each software. This test was aimed at finding how fast a user can create groups, chart of accounts, vouchers, etc. We also did other things, such as entering amounts so that the balance went negative, to see if the software generated errors or not, and to check if reordering worked or not.

We did not compare the products on pricing, as each vendor had different prices depending on the modules that they bundled. The scenario was not altogether simple; some had the base pack with the inventory bundled, others had a base pack with just the accounting module, and some had accounting, inventory and manufacturing modules within the base module.

Apart from these, ease of installation was also considered important.

## CompTax

CompTax, a software that aims to lessen the trouble of tax calculations, does not perform to its full potential.

It needs a lot of patchwork before it could be held as truly helpful. In its current state, CompTax does not perform any calculation. Instead, it provides you a multi-columnar grid to enter values. Why pay for software if you have to do the calculations manually. Instead, use Excel to do the same. To list a couple of examples, there's Taxable Prerequisites, Other exemption, etc.

The software does not consider an important aspect of Rebate-section VIII A due to investments into insurance, provident fund, public provident fund, etc. Omission of such an important feature renders it useless for individual users.

From the corporate point of view, it provides Form 16 reports, which is its single most important function. Other

features include calculation of advance and self-assessment taxes, deductions under section 88c (working women) and under section 88d (senior citizen), calcu-

lation of interest on National Saving Certificates (NSC), and calculation of interest payable under section 234A, 234B and 234C. However, it does not consider section 89(1) that deals with salary arrears.

CompTax does not let you enter salary figures month-wise. You have to manually sum up each element of your salary structure for the entire year and then enter them into the system.

All said and done, CompTax needs a lot of fine-tuning before it really kicks off.

| CompTax     |  | A- |   |   |   |   |
|-------------|--|----|---|---|---|---|
| Performance |  | ▶  | ▶ | ▶ | ▶ | ▶ |
| Features    |  | ▶  | ▶ | ▶ | ▶ | ▶ |
| Ease of Use |  | ▶  | ▶ | ▶ | ▶ | ▶ |
| Overall     |  | ▶  | ▶ | ▶ | ▶ | ▶ |

Price: Rs 3,250  
+ Helps in calculating taxes  
- Not very helpful features-wise

### Profile



K Murtuza is a Graduate Member of The Institute of Cost and Works Accountants of India, and a Fellow member of The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India.

Having qualified as a CA in 1995, he has 13 years of experience in accounting. He has worked with a leading firm of Chartered Accountants in

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Mumbai for almost eight years, carrying out a variety of Audit and Assurances services.

He was another one of the two experts that contributed informed opinions to this software test.